Tables

The following pages present tables looking at specific behaviours of individual children. They give the possible developmental trauma rationale and the possible executive functioning difficulty leading to these behaviours, as well as providing some ideas for interventions and strategies that may assist the pupil in changing the way he or she behaves.

There are no easy answers or quick fixes. As previously stated, these children need empathic support and boundaries to enable them to manage well. They need to know that the adults in their lives can keep them safe and that the expectations put upon them are within their capabilities.

Pupils of either gender can demonstrate any of these behaviours. For ease of reference, a mix has been used within the tables but behaviours themselves are not gender specific.

Within some of these tables, reference is made to the teacher expressing their understanding of early developmental trauma. This can serve to validate the child's own feelings. It is not intended to provide the pupil with an excuse, but to provide a rationale behind why he or she can find managing so difficult. The pupil needs to know that he or she has choices and that the adults are there to support the child in making the best and most appropriate choice. Of course, any reference to early life history can only be made if parents are in agreement with this approach, and confidentiality has to be respected at all times. Any reference needs to be made away from the locality of other pupils.

These tables have evolved through work with schools. They are not intended to be prescriptive but are representative of a framework with which to work. There are no strategies that always work with troubled children; each individual child has his/her own history, problems and needs. The strategies and interventions are possible avenues to explore but each table is founded on the basis that these children need empathy with containment. They need adults who can engage with them, provide structure for them and care for them. It is hoped that the tables will give ideas of how to incorporate interventions to support these children.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour - Absconding

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Leaving the classroom or school premises	A particular lesson, teacher or anticipated activity. An incident with a peer or teacher. A fear of abandonment. A need to check the presence of the care-giver. A realisation that he has forgotten a necessary resource.	Fear, insecurity, a sense of unworthiness, shame and rejection are all key to these types of behaviour. A need to abandon before being abandoned. Possibly peer pressure combined with his low self-esteem and a need to be accepted.	Validating the child's concern is important here. Keeping calm is crucial. If this child has a history of absconding, then, obviously, he needs to be closely supervised at all times and all staff need to be informed. The child needs to know that the adults in his life can keep him safe. He needs to understand that interventions to prevent him from absconding are measures to keep him safe rather than a punishment. If a group of peers are absconding together, police involvement may be necessary. Providing a photograph or item from home can give reassurance and can serve as a reminder that Mum will be collecting him.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitoring Possibly shift	Open discussion can help him to understand and appreciate adult concerns regarding his vulnerability and safety. Provide alternative strategies for him when he is feeling anxious or threatened e.g. allowing him the possibility of phoning his mum. Role-play scenarios so that these strategies can become embedded.

School policy will dictate the prevention and management of this behaviour. Initially, of course, the safety of the pupil is the primary concern, especially in the light of the vulnerability of these youngsters. Sanctions and consequences that further shame this pupil should be avoided.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour - Inability to Accept Blame

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Aggression towards teacher/teaching assistant or seeming to 'switch off' and not listen	Being reprimanded or expecting to be reprimanded for a misdemeanour, demonstrating an inability to accept blame or scolding	Shame – this child feels personally responsible for what has happened to her in the past; she may have been told that it was her fault or that it was what she wanted. She may feel that her actions led to her being taken away or to others being punished. 'Bad' behaviour in her early life may have led to unwarranted physical punishment – fear may be driving her inability or refusal to accept blame for her actions.	Pre-empt the response by acknowledging and validating the child's emotion, e.g. *"I can see this is very difficult for you."* Make any consequence appropriate but one that will not accentuate the shame or feelings of abandonment e.g. waiting outside a head teacher's office or spending time in another class. Draw a line under the incident when the sanction has been implemented. This child will not cope with a 'three-lives' approach. Avoid confrontational situations and do not insist on eye contact. To reduce shame, limit the reprimand to a ten-second scolding.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control	Possibly cognitive approaches e.g. role-play incidents; close supervision to avoid incidence of misdemeanours; adapting the environment to avoid possibility of negative behaviours. Do not ask, *"Why did you do this?"* She does not know the answer. If you KNOW she is responsible for the incident, then do not ask her, tell her, *"I know that you took the money and I understand how difficult it was for you to stop yourself when you saw the money on the desk."*
This child needs boundaries and needs to accept that there are consequences when she has overstepped those boundaries. However, her emotional development is below that expected for her chronological age and she needs the adults in her life to be her external regulators, adapting her environment as one would for a toddler so that the possibility of her failing is reduced.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Acting a victim

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ Developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Demonstrating fear of verbal or physical aggression from sibling, friend, classmate etc. Seeming to invite reactive responses from others. Some children display major upset over small hurts yet are impervious to major hurts.	Any setting where this pupil mixes with children whom she perceives as intimidating or threatening.	This pupil's early life history could have involved siblings competing for attention, food, nurture etc. in order to survive with a possibility that attention could have focused around sexual abuse. Siblings could have been the 'favourites' whilst this child was victimised or neglected. The siblings could have been encouraged to be abusive towards each other. This child may feel she is within her comfort zone, replicating her early environment. Aggressive relationships could have been the example set by the adults in their lives. This child may have very little self-esteem, and could be feeling responsible for what has happened in the past with the resultant shame.	Children's safety (both physical and emotional) is the important issue here. Monitor the situation to ensure clarification of what is actually happening. Validate the child's feelings. *"I know how difficult this is for you. The adults in your life will keep you safe."* Avoid settings in which this child can become a victim; if the problem is sibling related, separate siblings within the playground or arrange separate playtimes if necessary. Find opportunities to develop this child's self-esteem. Provide opportunities for her to talk to an understanding adult. She may need support to do this. Give her a token she can hand to you if she is worried, especially if she finds it hard to talk.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitor	Role-play scenarios, helping the child to find alternative responses. Social skills groups can provide support. Help her to think about her emotions. Use smiley face stickers to help her begin to desensitise herself – One colour for when she feels anxious, another colour when she was hurt. The differences between the two might help her to get her feelings into perspective.
Children who have not had the opportunity to develop a primary attachment with their parents find it difficult to manage secondary attachments. Children who have suffered early developmental trauma often experience peer problems. Victimization can be real or imaginary, and it can be frustrating for adults who are implementing interventions if it appears that the pupil courts aggression from others. Teachers need to recognise that however imaginary the feelings are, they are real to the child. Her behaviour needs to be seen as her language, demonstrating possible anxiety and fear. Let her know you understand this and can empathise with her difficulties.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Careless Errors

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ Developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Rushing work, assignments; careless errors	Fear of being reprimanded for being slow, or for getting something wrong. Competitiveness leads to rushing. Not feeling good enough about himself to 'get it right'.	The child may have been triggered into a trauma reaction and literally can't think about schoolwork. Need for control – this child may have unpleasant memories of when others controlled his life. His need for control over his work is crucial to him. Shame – he feels an immense shadow of shame for what has happened to him and his lack of self-worth leads to a need to 'prove himself' by rushing. Alternatively, he may make mistakes as getting things right may not 'fit' with how he sees himself. Compliance– this pupil may wish to please his teacher and so rushes his work to gain his/her praise for speed.	Validate the child's feelings away from the rest of the class. *"I'm really pleased how quickly you can complete your work and now I want you to try to manage this without any errors. Would you like some support in this?"* For a pupil who is easily shamed, a row of crosses against his work, especially if he was hoping to gain praise, may further add to his shame. A row of crosses may also confirm the child's view of himself as lacking worth. It may help the child if you remind him that he is liked however he answers the questions.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Planning and organising Working memory	Remind by a statement before the lesson. *"I know how quickly you can manage to complete your work. For this piece of work, I want you to try to think a bit more before you write down the answers."* Provide planning sheets. Support the pupil in saying a mantra. Ensure that the task is appropriate to the child's ability so that he can succeed in not making errors. His errors could be because he was unable to process the instructions.
This child could have hyperactive tendencies and these could underlie his rush to get work finished. If he can move onto something he enjoys, either routinely or as a reward, this could be his reason for rushing. However, whatever the reason, an empathic approach may well have more effect than a demanding one.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Cheating

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Cheating at team games, board games etc.		Need for control – this child may have unpleasant memories of when others controlled his life. His need for control is crucial to him. Shame – he feels an immense shadow of shame for what has happened to him and his lack of self-worth leads to a need to 'prove himself'. Survival strategy – this child may have needed to be manipulative, 'cheat' or 'be the best' to keep alive and safe.	Validate the child's feelings. *"I know you find it hard if you lose but you need to realise that others get upset if you cheat."* Try to engineer the situation so that the pupil plays with others who can act as role-models and who can manage their own emotions if he does not play fairly.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Working memory	Reminding by a statement before the lesson. *"I know how important it is to you to win at games."* Ensure that the game is appropriate to the child's ability so that he can succeed without cheating. It may be that the child has not been able to process all the instructions or does not have the skills and knowledge to play the game according to how it should be played. Role-play scenarios where the pupil loses and teach him strategies or mantras that he can use in this situation. *"This is not a big deal. I may win another time."* Provide him with set vocabulary that he can use e.g. *"Well done. Thank you for playing with me."*
Many of these children have difficulties managing peer relationships and cheating at team and board games is likely to inflame these relationships further. There are many games available commercially that are not competitive and that might help him to engage with others in a non-competitive way.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Compliant and helpful

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ Developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
This child never presents problematic or disruptive behaviour and is often not considered to have any problems. She always seems to be trying hard and is often helpful and reliable. If one knows the trauma that she has experienced, one might think how well she is managing in spite of her past.	Everyday living will result in this compliancy.	Under this people-pleasing behaviour, there probably lies an incredibly anxious child who is desperate to please to avoid further rejection. Keeping up this act requires boundless energy and can be draining. For some of these youngsters, it is later in life that they can analyse their early behaviours and their knowledge of living this lie can lead to depression.	These children need to know that they will still be accepted whatever their behaviour. Give specific praise and accept some offers of help but discourage others – "*That's really good of you to offer but I think some of the rest of the class need to start taking some of this responsibility, don't you?*" If there is a lapse in behaviour, try to accept it and don't be tempted to say *"Well Jenny, I thought you knew better than that. I thought I could rely on you."* Although this may be hard, it might be appropriate to be pleased that this behaviour may signal that she is feeling secure enough to demonstrate her anxieties.	Often, assessments of these children's executive skills show good control of most. Their scores do not appear in the clinically high range.	The inner struggle to control her feelings needs to be recognised. Try to lessen the pressure for her to behave well at all times. Your management of 'naughtier' children may influence her understanding. She may be able to see that bad behaviour does not equate with rejection of the person.

Some of these children are able to control their behaviour at home as well as school. If this is not addressed, they can experience problems later in life.

However, it may well be that this child displays completely contrasting behaviour at home. The child may seem to change dramatically even as she walks out of school to meet her parents. The parents, themselves, may be struggling to contain challenging behaviour and her compliant behaviour at school may add to their feelings of rejection and failure. They may feel that staff at school do not believe them or consider them 'bad parents'. They need professionals who can show an understanding of the situation, and who offer support and empathy.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Constant Fiddling

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
This child fiddles continuously – shoes, clothing, adjacent furniture etc.	Possible anxiety about what is coming next.	This could be part of A.D.H.D. behaviour. It could be due to sensory arousal. It is likely that it is based in anxiety – many of these children live in a constant state of anxiety, sometimes not even feeling the security that they will be returning to the same home after school. Fiddling can be a way to use up excess adrenaline, levels of which may be heightened due to early life experiences.	Accept this child's need to fiddle and work with it. Provide him with a suitable fiddling toy – one that won't make a noise, roll away or be dangerous to others. It needs to be something that you are content with, and you then need to feel at ease with him doing this. Encourage the support of his peers by accepting that this is a difficulty for this child.	Behaviour inhibition – an inability to stop himself Possibly shift – a lack of security as to what is coming next	Try to alleviate any school anxieties that this child may have. Give warning of changes to routine, for example. Build into the school day lots of short physical breaks. Incorporate more kinaesthetic learning opportunities. Allow him to 'doodle' during inputs if necessary.

The other members of the class will accept that this child needs this intervention if it is presented to them as a difficulty. If the teacher is positive, children will follow this lead and may be incredibly supportive towards this child, even fetching the resource for him if he forgets. Any initial distraction that this may cause will disappear quickly as the whole class accepts the need. This is also a very positive learning opportunity for other children who can be helped to accept difference in all its facets.
Diet may play a part here. Although the school rarely has a direct influence over diet, curriculum coverage of nutrition can help to educate the child himself and consideration may be helpful at school parties etc.
Within school policy, snacks permitted at breaks may be issues that need to be addressed for the benefit of all pupils.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Coursework Issues

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Not handing in coursework, not doing coursework.	The expectation of achievement which threatens his view of himself as a failure. The fear of failure. Control issues may play a part in this	Control – this pupil knows that this is one area of his life over which he can exercise some control. This need for control possibly arises from the period in his life where he had no control and suffered. Shame – an inner feeling that what he achieves will not be good enough. This pupil will not have any internalised acceptance of the importance of education, and its effect on one's future place within the working community. He will be unable to internalise this idea because he does not believe in himself. Therefore, he has no internal incentive to complete this work.	Adapt expectations so that the pupil only has to complete essential work, ensuring that this is thoroughly explained to both pupil and parents. Provide clear, written guidelines for the work including dates the work is due in. Chunk any extended work into sections that can be monitored by teachers on a short-term basis. Encourage the pupil to attend homework facilities at school where he can be assisted by staff in a controlled, but supportive, environment.	Organisation of task and materials Self-monitoring Initiate	The teacher needs to take more responsibility for monitoring this pupil's work. Chunking coursework and insisting on seeing each part will prevent the last-minute approach that these pupils tend to practise.

Try to bear in mind that control issues at home sometimes mean that parents may have to engage in huge control battles to ensure the child completes homework; this may be potentially more difficult than in most households. It is important to validate the parents' difficulties and recognise that, at times, homework is less of a priority than in other situations. The priority for this family might be to foster attachments. Engaging in control battles around homework issues may be counter-productive to this. Adoptive parents are likely to have committed themselves emotionally and practically to providing the best for their child. Because of the child's difficulties, this commitment may involve more frequent communication between teachers and parents, and it is acknowledged that this can be problematic with the growing pressures on teachers' time. However, this pupil may be unable to take as much charge of his own education as most pupils can at this chronological age. He may display a defensive, uncaring exterior but it is important that he can see school and parents working together, supporting him.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Dangerous behaviour

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Dangerous and irresponsible behaviour – either to himself or to others e.g. uncontrolled behaviour on P.E. apparatus, playground equipment, in the swimming pool or with design technology tools.	A feeling of insecurity or feeling unsafe A memory from the past, possibly subconscious A lack of attention from adults. If this is a control issue, the knowledge of the importance the adults place on the safety of the situation. Self-harming behaviours	This child may not have received the normal parenting techniques imposed on toddlers i.e. being allowed to explore the 'outside' world in a structured environment under close parental supervision. This experience of lack of boundaries may have led to an inability to perceive danger or the need to keep 'safe' He may have little or no concept of cause and effect. Shame could lead him to put himself into situations where he may get hurt 'purposely'. Control – a need to demonstrate that he has control over his life.	This child needs to be kept safe and so the environment needs to be adapted to enable this. Speak to him about the worry his behaviour causes and the need for you to keep him safe. *"It may be that when you were a baby, adults didn't keep you safe. I need to help you learn how to keep safe. You need to practise keeping safe when you go on the apparatus, so we will try on the little apparatus first. When I know you can manage that, then we will try the large apparatus."* Or *"We are the adults in your life and we need to keep you safe, so we are not allowing you on the playground equipment until you can show us that you can use it safely."* One needs to 'think toddler' and ensure that he is constantly monitored, with the environment/timetable modified to allow this.	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control – no boundary for fear Self-monitor Planning and organising	This child needs the adults in his life to act as his external regulators. Verbalise the need to keep safe and involve him in considering tactics to keep himself safe. Talk through these repeatedly so that he can start internalising this. Practise using the apparatus on a one-to-one basis. Video him when he is using the apparatus safely and talk him through the safety aspects as you watch it with him.

Obviously, a dangerous situation needs to be stopped immediately but safely – this child may not comprehend, for example, that the quickest way down from a height is probably not the safest! If the safety of the child or other children is jeopardised, then interventions need to be implemented, but try to make these non-shaming. *"I can see you may not manage to keep yourself and others safe in this lesson so we are going to work on a different project in another room."* This child is behaving in this manner because of the impact of his past life history and really inwardly wants to be able to join in with the others. Having the child watch other children having fun in the pool, for example, is shaming.
If self harming is an issue: *"I'm sad you don't feel good enough about yourself to practise safe behaviour. Because I value you I need to make sure you are safe by….."*

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Inability to keep desk/locker clean and tidy

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
This child's desk or locker is continually messy, filled with scrappy papers, left-over food etc.	Being asked to tidy up or thinking that the teacher will not notice if the items are in the drawer and not in view on the desk.	This child may have started life in chaotic surroundings and has an in-built need to replicate that. She may feel the need to hoard food as a learnt survival strategy– she may not have received adequate food when young or may have needed to fight for it. The food could be there as she has food issues and her parents are monitoring her food intake. Worksheets may be 'hidden' within the mess as she was unable to focus on these and they remain unfinished. Control issues – she feels in control of her own space, although the state of the locker is perceived as uncontrolled by the adults around her.	Avoid reprimanding for disorganisation, and avoid shaming in front of peers, for example because of the smells emanating from the locker! Applying very carefully chosen humour can sometimes lighten the situation. Verbalise your understanding – *"I know you find this really hard."* Allow extra individual time for accessing the locker to avoid her trying to cope in the rush of others. Provide adult or caring, sensible peer support.	Inability to organise materials Planning and organising tasks	She will need on-going support with this. She will need specific instructions e.g. *"Let's clear out the smelly food first"*. Show her where the nearest waste-bin is so she can use this in future. Demonstrate how to check to see which papers are important. Coach how to pile books in size order so they are instantly visible. Allow specified time for organising desks/lockers, perhaps timetabling a weekly session with a teaching assistant as support.

Food issues are included here as food invariably ends up inside a desk or locker! For children who have experienced neglect or abuse, food issues are often well-established and need a careful approach. The child may benefit by being given a pictorial representation of how to tidy her desk. Take a photograph of the untidy desk, then one with the food tidied away, then one with the papers tidied etc. Try to involve the child in taking the photographs as this will give her a sense of ownership of the process. It would be best to laminate the finished product. The child can use her photographic programme to help her know what to do; she may need adult support to do this. If the untidy desk is a reflection of how the child feels about herself, you may need to work on issues of self esteem and give the child the message *"Won't it be great when you feel good enough about yourself to have a tidy desk."*

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Inability to turn up for detention

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to attend detention or return to a given sanction after eating lunch, at the end of the day etc.	Possibly an issue at playtime, a conversation, a perception of injustice, a disappointment, an argument at home etc. A fear of rejection, reprimand, isolation. He could be struggling to manage consequences of behaviour.	Fear - He may be afraid he will not be able to manage his emotions and may be frightened that these could escalate out of control. If the consequence involves isolation, the isolation could trigger traumatic memories of early neglect, especially if he is undergoing therapy or life-story work. Shame – This child may feel responsible for the trauma in his early life. He may be struggling to manage his behaviour and is further shamed by receiving a detention. Control – he may feel a need to be in control and not to be subject to parameters set by adults. Developmental trauma can impact on a child's sensory development. He may become over-stimulated by a busy environment and be unable to remember to attend.	Validate his feelings e.g. *"I know you find it difficult to remember to go to detention. Let's see if I can help you with this."* These children need 'time-in' rather than 'time-out'. Consequences that involve an expectation for the child to manage independently when he is feeling dysregulated can ignite further dysregulation. They need a supportive adult to be with them.	Working Memory Shift Plan/organise Behaviour inhibition Emotional control	If the problem is connected just to remembering or planning, the use of external cues can help – alarms on watches, telephones, palm-pilots. This pupil may need reminding to set these alarms; pagers and phone calls when a pupil can be personally reminded; the use of existing external cues e.g. when the lunch bell rings. It can be helpful to run through a visualisation technique with the pupil, imagining where he will be when the bell rings and what he needs to do when he hears it. If the pupil does not want to make the shift from what he is doing, validate this as the child may not be able to verbalise this himself. *"I can see that you probably don't want to leave your friends, but you do need to go to detention."*
Obviously all children need boundaries and need to know that behaviour that crosses these boundaries is unacceptable. There is also a need for disciplinary procedures to be consistent and fair to all pupils. However, the consequence should be appropriate to the deed and there needs to be an understanding that this pupil may well be struggling with managing to keep within the boundaries not because he is being purposely defiant but because of the above issues. If the child is constantly receiving detentions, it possibly demonstrates that this consequence is not working for him and that perhaps interventions need to be implemented to support him. Increasing detention for failing to attend for detention will be likely to exacerbate the problem.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Food Issues

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible Attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Food issues – hiding her packed lunch and queuing for a school dinner, eating others' lunch, eating no lunch, eating inappropriately, an inability to follow instructions during food technology, 'forgetting ingredients' etc.	Lunchtime, any occasion where food is involved e.g. snacks at break times, cookery, food technology, picnics, another pupil having sweets at school etc.	There are many possibilities for this. This child may have experienced extreme hunger. She may have suffered an inadequate, or ill-balanced diet. She may have had to fight others for food or eaten non-food objects. She may be unused to the type of food on offer. She may have undergone periods of food poisoning due to poor food hygiene practices. She may see food issues as an easy way of maintaining control over her own life. Eating disorders are often a way of coping with difficult feelings. She may have been responsible for preparing food for herself and others.	Close supervision to avoid temptation, worry or conflict, without reprimands. Analysis of the situation to define the true nature of the difficulty. Validation of her feelings, *"I know lunchtime is difficult for you. I will be here to support you."* Keeping care-givers informed of any incidents and ensuring care-givers keep the school informed of any changes, considering the possibility of changing to school dinners/packed lunch/going home for lunch.	Difficulties with self-monitoring. An inability to look at her own behaviours in context Emotional control Behaviour inhibition	Talk to her to involve her in considering strategies to help her; put a regime in place where she receives extra support e.g. support from a teaching assistant, keeping her packed lunch in a different place to others, checking early in the day whether she will have packed lunch or school dinner. Create a specific verbal routine that can be said to her until she is able to internalise it.
Lunchtimes can be traumatising for any pupil when starting a new school. Dining halls are often very busy and noisy – settings that are very difficult for children with sensory and perceptual problems. Eating within an institution demands regimes and instructions that can be quite daunting for pupils who cannot process large amounts of information at one time. Some pupils may be unused to sitting at a table to eat or to using cutlery. For pupils taking a packed lunch from home, there are peer pressures relating to the content, as well as possible pressures from school staff regarding healthy eating. Food issues need to be handled carefully. Serious food issues may need trained medical support and assistance.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours –Forgetting Resources

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to remember items for school, to take home necessary items, to have resources necessary for a lesson.		This child may have come from a chaotic household and does not yet understand the value of organisation. Shame – this child feels personally responsible for what has happened to her in the past; this affects her self-esteem which affects her ability to complete everyday tasks effectively.	When this child has not got an item, it is probable that she has been unable to remember it. Showing anger compounds the shame that she is already feeling due to her inaptitude. It is better to verbalise understanding of this difficulty, *"I know how hard it is for you to remember to bring your bag/book/pencils to school. Let's see how we can support you with this."*	Organisation of materials Self-monitor Planning	Practical support – teaching how to make and use lists, photographic reminders of resources for school, and for those she needs to take home. Copies of colour-coded timetables in the school bag, locker, at home. Ensure exercise and textbooks are clearly labelled for the subjects, possibly using corresponding coloured stickers. Provide an external regulator to guide and support, rather than do it for her. If necessary, provide a special place for her to keep her books in the classroom.
Working together with home is important here. Try to implement strategies that are consistent and connected. Provide photographic lists for home as well as at school. Support the care-giver in realising that the child needs support to do this herself. Demonstrate to the child that school and home are supporting her with this. Providing transparent pencil cases and named resources can help, along side extra copies of text books at home.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Inability to Focus on Group Work

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Inability to focus on own group's activity, possibly disrupting other groups, curiosity of other activities	Dividing class into groups to work on activities around classroom/ hall/playground leading to the child being unsure of what everyone else is doing.	Need for hypervigilance – survival strategy learnt as a baby. Although the child is not threatened in this environment he probably feels as if he is. This child 'needs' to know what is going on and is unable to focus on one activity when there is much activity around him. He may also have difficulty if asked to choose between activities as he will not want to 'miss out' on one activity for another. Control issues – a need to be able to manage everything. The 'buzz' in the class as children move to their groups can be stressful for this child.	Try a variety of working arrangements e.g. positioning the child so there is no threat from behind, positioning the child close to an adult. Validate the child's need to know all that is going on – "*I can see you find it very difficult to focus on your group.*" "*I can see you are worried about what else is going on in the classroom.*" Possibly take the child round the other groups first to satisfy his need. Limit choices and help him to choose if necessary – "*Let me look for you. Oh, I can see it's a sand tray day for you today.*"	Attention focus. Emotional control – anxiety Shift – knowing that he will need to move from one activity to another	Provide adult intervention to refocus child periodically. Place child with a group of pupils who can act as role-models. Provide a concrete timer so child knows how long this activity will last. Support the child at the beginning and end of each task. Validate his feelings verbally.

Developmental trauma often impacts on the sensory development of these children. Many demonstrate problems with focusing and are easily distracted by the 'busy' environment of the classroom. Primary classrooms often have beautiful wall displays and hanging mobiles; some of these children can find this too stimulating. They may benefit from sitting in an area that is least cluttered, possibly facing a blank wall. The child may need to work on his own at times and 'practise' short periods in a group setting. This must not be presented as a punishment and care may have to be taken to ensure the child does not feel rejected. "*I noticed you struggled yesterday to sit with your group. Why don't you sit with me for 15 minutes and you can join your group for the last 5 minutes. That will give you a chance to practise being in your group.*" It's important that you choose the amount of time in the group carefully; choose the number of minutes you know the child can manage and suggest 2 minutes less; that way he can experience success rather than failure. If you allow him to join only to remove him when he is struggling he will experience this as failure. Similarly it's better for the child to join at the end rather than the beginning of the activity. He will benefit from adult attention and this should place him more in a position to manage. Also removal after time in the group may feel like failure however it is presented.

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Homework Issues

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Not handing in homework Not doing homework	Being asked to hand in homework Parental or teacher expectation of achievement	Control – this child knows that this is one area of his life over which he can exercise some control. This need for control possibly arises from the period in his life where he had no control and suffered. Shame – this child may feel personally responsible for what has happened to him in the past; he may have been told that it was his fault or that it was what he wanted. He may feel that his actions led to him being taken away or to others being punished. He feels 'rubbish' and has an inner feeling that what he achieves will not be good enough. Fear - of reprisals, reprimands, consequences.	Adapt the homework expectations – constant reprimands for incomplete or non-existent homework add to the shame of the child and the frustration of the teacher. In agreement with parents, minimise homework to the essential tasks and differentiate the task to meet his ability.	Planning and organising Organisation of task Self-monitoring Initiate Working memory	Gently, and not in front of others, supervise him checking his schoolbag in case he has produced work but has not managed to hand it in. Provide written instructions so that he can be helped when he has forgotten or not absorbed what to do. Provide formats to simplify the 'starting process'. Ensure the pupil understands the criteria of the homework.
Try to bear in mind that control issues at home sometimes make working together to complete homework potentially more difficult than in most households. However, it is our experience that adoptive and foster parents are very supportive of their child's education and wish to become involved. Establishing good communication networks is especially beneficial for these pupils, as they need to see that they are important enough for the adults in their lives to work together in their interest.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Hypochondriac tendencies

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Complaining constantly of minor ailments. Often children who get very upset over minor things will be impervious to major hurts or accidents.	Triggers could range from a variety of concerns e.g. inability to understand instructions, work they feel unable to complete, or a smell, sound, word, picture that produces a traumatic memory. The week-end or morning could have been difficult at home.	This behaviour may well be linked to a hope that the ailment will enable the child to be sent home. A need to return home is likely to stem from anxiety due to something that is happening within the school setting, something that they know is happening at home or possibly anxiety about rejection and abandonment. Many children live with a fear that this caregiver will not be returning at home-time to collect them. They may be acting this way to gain reassurance from the teacher or parent. Some children who cannot express their feelings overtly will use 'illness' to express their inner feelings. These aches and pains can be very real for the child.	Constant surveillance of the child to intervene if he seems to be becoming anxious. A photograph or memento of home at hand to present for reassurance. Validate the child's feelings. Accept that the child's stomach ache is real and say this – "*Gosh, I can see you are really not feeling great at the moment. Mum thought you might have a problem today and she asked me to give you this.*" - a card or note that mum has provided in advance.	Emotional control – this child has not yet learnt how to calm himself. Possibly shift if the anxiety is provoked by moving from one activity to another, or by the presence of a supply teacher	Try to warn the child of any impending change and be reassuring. Act as a role-model. Verbalise instances when you start to feel anxious and strategies you use to calm yourself. Validate the child's underlying feeling. "*I guess if I was really hurting inside I might have stomach pains.*" Allow the child a special routine for coming into school so you can recognise immediately if he is experiencing problems.
School policy will dictate the circumstances for sending children home – no teacher wants an ill child in their class. However, one needs to monitor individual children. This child is demonstrating his needs and extra time at home may help to secure attachments; however this needs to be dictated by the adults rather than the child. If it is viable, allowing this child a certain time of the week when he can spend extra personal time with his caregiver can alleviate these behaviours. This is especially important if the child has siblings also vying for the caregiver's attention. If a child becomes accustomed to 'using' health issues to deal with emotional problems this could have long term negative mental health consequences. It is vital that he is helped to address his feelings openly and get help to deal with these.					

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviours – Inability to Focus on a Task

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Lack of focus, inability to begin task. This sometimes involves, for example, chatting to others, fiddling, sharpening pencils, seeming to copy others' work, going to the toilet or just sitting doing nothing.	Being given new task Being given too many or too complex instructions.	Shame – anxiety about being wrong. This child may have been in an environment where she lived in a constant state of fear. She may have been blamed for her and others' actions. She may feel an overwhelming sense of responsibility for what has happened to her and others close to her. Need for hypervigilance – survival strategy learnt as a baby. Although she may not actually feel threatened in this environment, this child 'needs' to know what is going on and is unable to focus. Developmental trauma can impact on a child's sensory development. She may become over-stimulated by a busy environment and be unable to cope. Neurobiologically, this child's processing skills may have been affected.	Validate her feelings e.g. *"I know you find starting and sticking to tasks difficult. I can see you worry about being wrong. Let's see if I can help you with this."* Provide adult support at the start and during the task. Arrange the seating arrangements so she sits with supportive peers who can act as role-models. Try to ensure she is sitting in a part of the classroom that is least cluttered.	Initiate Working memory Planning and organising	Chunk the work, asking child to complete and show work in parts. (The timing of this will be dependent on the emotional age and needs of the child. Younger children will need to show work more frequently.) Provide a schema, a planning sheet or format for work. Use simple explicit instructions, giving only one or two instructions at a time. Consider the possible need for individual instructions, and repeat next instruction as the child works. Consider the seating arrangement for the child.

These children are not lazy, and many would love to be among the group who complete their work first. Assessments provide extra anxiety, and these children may look at others' work not necessarily to copy, but more in horror that peers around them are managing to complete their assessments. If they do copy, then this need is activated by their inner anxieties. There may be occasions in the classroom when copying can be accepted as an opportunity for good role-modelling.
Provide resources at hand so she is organised for the task, and give her short, achievable targets.
Build in natural breaks, e.g. use an egg-timer with instructions to show her work to an adult at the end of the time. Be encouraging, rather than reprimanding, e.g. *"I can see you are having a problem here. You need more practice at getting started. Let me do the first sentence for you, then you do the next 2 sentences and show me what you've done."*

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Analysis of Observed or Reported Behaviour – Intense Sibling Rivalry

Behaviour	Possible trigger	Possible attachment/ developmental trauma issue	Possible intervention	Possible executive skill difficulty	Possible intervention
Verbal or physical aggression towards sibling, intense tale-telling about sibling or fear of sibling. Seeking out the sibling, perhaps in the context of 'helping'.	Incidents prior to arrival at school, home-time, playtimes, whole-school occasions, settings where two classes mix e.g. paired reading, shared 'news' reminding pupil of earlier incident.	This pupil's early life history could have involved siblings competing for attention, food, nurture etc. in order to survive. There is a possibility attention could have focused around sexual abuse. One sibling could have been the 'favourite' whist others were victimised or neglected. The children could have been encouraged to be abusive towards each other. Aggressive relationships could have been the example set by adults in their lives.	Avoiding settings where the siblings meet up will ensure their safety, both physical and emotional. If this is not possible, ensure adult support is available for each sibling. Be available to talk things out if the children need to. Perhaps, provide them with an item to give you if they wish to talk or use a toy for them to talk through. Do not put any pressure on them to chat though. Validate the children's difficulties verbally. *"I can see how difficult this is for you."* Give reassurance to a child who is afraid of her sibling. *"I know you worry about being hurt. We are going to help you feel safe."*	Behaviour inhibition Emotional control Self-monitor	Role-play possible scenarios to explore alternative responses. Direct children to different areas of the playground. Remind children of your expectations of behaviour before they meet up. *"I know how hard it is for you when we all play in the field together. I am going to help you keep to the far side of the path so your sister can play safely this side of the path."* *"If you see your brother, I expect you to wave to him. Remember not to go near to him and hit him."* After play, talk with the child in a non-shaming way about how she managed.
Although it may appear that one child is the perpetrator, be aware that each sibling is actually a victim. The behaviour of the abusive sibling is her language, demonstrating her anxiety and unhappiness. It is important to be honest about this child's behaviour in a non-shaming way – *"I know that you sometimes hit your sister. I guess you learnt to do this when you were little. I want to help you be with your sister in a different way. This will help you feel better about yourself and keep your sister safe."*					

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